



AKC CGC Prep

CGC Skill 3 · Grooming & Handling Checklist



FITDOG TRAINING ACADEMY

Appearance and Grooming Handling

Master cgc item 3.

Your dog accepts light grooming and handling from the evaluator — ears, front feet, and a brief brush — without fear, mouthing, or escape attempts.

TRAINER NOTE

CGC prep is about reliable real-life manners — not perfection under pressure. Practice below threshold, log your reps,

Start here

Dog's name

Target test date

Handler name

Best reward

Know the criteria

Dog welcomes being groomed and examined by evaluator. Evaluator

1 **Official skill criteria**
Evaluator lightly combs or brushes, examines ears, and picks up fr

Handler mechanics

Bring a brush your dog already ac-
cepts.

End on success

Stop while your dog can still think,
eat, and cooperate.

CGC ITEM 3

Dog welcomes being groomed and examined by evaluator. Evaluator lightly combs or brushes, examines ears, and picks up front foot. Owner supplies brush/comb.

2 **Handler checklist**

- ☐ Bring a brush your dog already accepts.
- ☐ One body part at a time — ears, then paws.
- ☐ Chin rest on your hand during handling.
- ☐ Stop before your dog shakes off or pulls away.

Supplies needed

- 6-ft leash
- Front-clip harness
- High-value treats



CGC PRACTICE · FITDOG

3 Step-by-step practice plan

Practice chin rest on your hand while you touch ears for 2 seconds.

Introduce a soft brush — one stroke, treat, release.

Have a helper examine front paws while you feed steadily.

Stand your dog on a non-slip mat for mock exam handling.

End before your dog pulls away or shakes off.

4 Common reasons dogs fail this item

☐ Pulling foot away

☐ Mouthiness during exam

☐ Refusing brush

☐ Owner forcing handling

5 Weekly practice log

Date	Setup	Duration	Success 1–5	Notes / next step
Day 1	Easy environment	5 min		
Day 2	Add one distraction	5 min		
Day 3	Hold difficulty	5 min		
Day 4	New location	5 min		
Day 5	Review + film	5 min		

1
Over
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3
Week-
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5
Test-
ready



TEST DAY · READINESS

6 Test-day readiness checklist

FITDOG TRAINER HOMEWORK

Grooming comfort on test day starts with tiny, rewarded touches at home.

- ☐ Brush in bag
- ☐ Ear + paw touches at home this week
- ☐ Dog exercised before test

7 Self-score before scheduling your evaluation

Question	Yes	Not yet
Dog succeeds 4/5 reps in practice this week		
Handler can explain criteria without reading notes		
Dog can eat treats in practice environment		
No safety concerns (bite risk, panic, escape)		
Ready to schedule official CGC evaluation		

REA Schedule evaluation — stack wins look solid

HOL Another 2 weeks of practice at this skill

HEL Contact Fitdog for trainer support

8 Notes for your trainer or evaluator

Observation	Details
Strongest rep this week	
Hardest moment	
Equipment that helped	
Question for test day	